

10. My Brilliant Career by Miles Franklin

- i. 'My Brilliant Career is both a romance story and an anti-romance story.'

Discuss.

OR

- ii. Franklin approves of Sybylla's behaviour and views her as a heroine?

Do you agree?

11. Oedipus the King by Sophocles

- i. 'Is there a moral or a meaning to the terrible story of King Oedipus?'

Discuss.

OR

- ii. 'Is it in his struggle to avoid his fate or his acceptance of it that makes Oedipus a hero?'

Discuss.

12. Pride and Prejudice by Jane Austen

- i. 'Both Elizabeth and Mr Darcy have to be humiliated before they can grow.'

Do you agree?

OR

- ii. 'Is Elizabeth right in saying that Darcy was attracted to her because she treated him differently to other women?'

Discuss.

19. *We Have Always Lived in the Castle* by Shirley Jackson

- i. 'There is a mysterious kind of innocence in both Merricat and Constance Blackwood that makes them sympathetic characters.'

Do you agree?

OR

- ii. '*We Have Always Lived in the Castle* is a kind of gentle and soothing horror story.'

Discuss.

20. *William Wordsworth: Poems* selected by Seamus Heaney

- i. 'Wordsworth seeks a joy that will relieve his sadness.'

Discuss.

OR

- ii. 'Wordsworth is able to make a philosophy to live by from his experience of Nature.'

Do you agree?

Framework 1: Writing about country

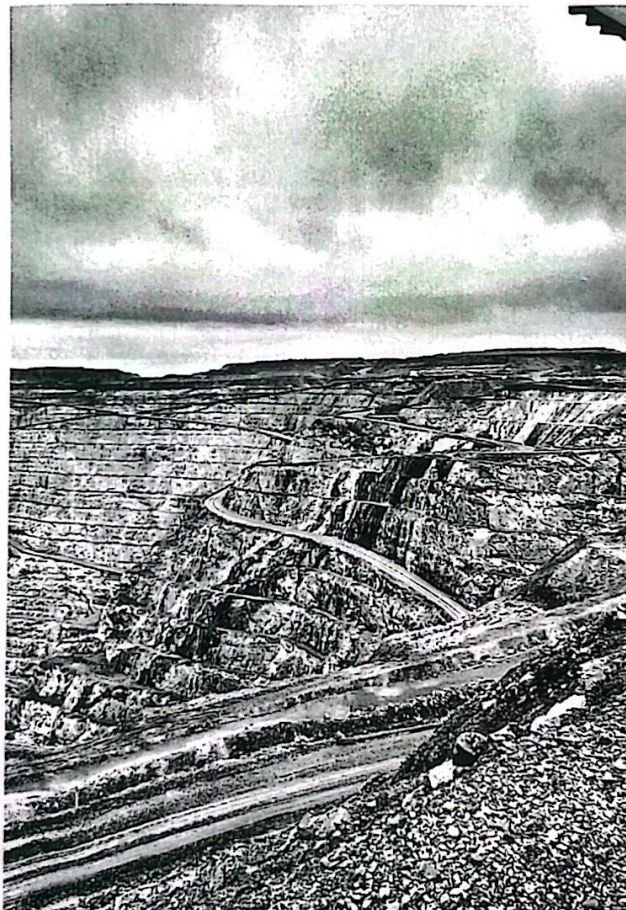
- Write a text that explores ideas about country.
- You must use the title provided.
- You must use **at least one** of the following stimuli.

Title: 'Living and working on the land'

Stimulus 1

'An Acknowledgement of Country is an opportunity for anyone to show respect for Traditional Owners and the continuing connection of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peoples to Country.'

Stimulus 2



An open cut mine by Matthew de Livera on Unsplash

Stimulus 3

'The classic song *Way Out West* written by The Dingoes tells the story of a man who leaves his job and wife in the city to work for a mining company, and how he enjoys 'living and a working on the land'.

The band sing about the strange change from working nine to five and that: 'At last I get the feeling that I'm really alive.'

Framework 2: Writing about protest

- Write a text that explores ideas about protest.
- You must use the title provided.
- You must use **at least one** of the following stimuli.

Title: 'Which side are you on'

Stimulus 1

'One has a moral responsibility to disobey unjust laws.'

Martin Luther King Jr.

Stimulus 2

Photo by Justin Essah on Unsplash

Stimulus 3

'Don't scab for the bosses
Don't listen to their lies
Us poor folks haven't got a chance
Unless we organize'

Sung by Pete Seeger and written by Florence Patton Reece.

Framework 3: Writing about personal journeys

- Write a text that explores ideas about personal journeys.
- You must use the title provided.
- You must use at least one of the following stimuli.

Title: 'Just be yourself.'

Stimulus 1

'Our choices are usually limited, and sometimes we have no choice at all.'

Stimulus 2



DALL-E-2

Stimulus 3

'There are always at least two sides to a story,
And both of them can be true and untrue.'

Framework 4: Writing about play

- Write a text that explores ideas about play.
- You must use the title provided.
- You must use **at least one** of the following stimuli.

Title: 'It's all a game'

Stimulus 1

'You can discover more about a person in an hour of play than in a year of conversation.'
Plato

Stimulus 2



Photo by spikeball on Unsplash

Stimulus 3

'Creative people are curious, flexible, persistent, and independent with a tremendous spirit of adventure and a love of play.'

Henri Matisse

Section C – Analysis of argument and language

Instructions

In this section, you are required to analyse the use of argument(s) and language to persuade an intended audience to share the point of view expressed in an unseen persuasive text.

- Read the background information on this page and the material on pages 16 and 17, and write an analytical response to the task below.
- For the purposes of this task, the term 'language' refers to written and spoken language, and 'visuals' refers to images and graphics.
- Refer to the assessment criteria on page 18.
- This section is worth one-third of the total marks for the examination.

TASK

Write an analysis of the ways in which argument(s), written and spoken language, and visuals are used in the material on pages 16 and 17 to try to persuade the intended audience to share the point of view presented.

Background information

The following text is an **opinion piece** by a **newspaper columnist** commenting on the **claim by the Australian Medical Association that the sport of boxing should be banned**.

Arguments:

1. Risk of boxing is lower than AMA make it out to be → lose trust in AMA
- 2.

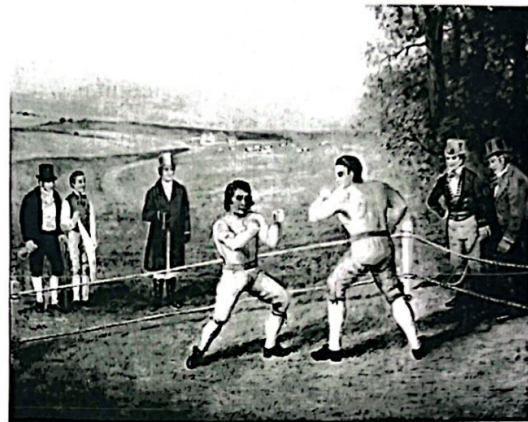
The Risk in Boxing is Justified

The Australian Medical Association has called for the banning of boxing and similar combat sports for many years. The AMA does not claim that boxing is particularly dangerous because the injuries and deaths from boxing and other combat sports are comparatively low rather than high.

According to the National Coronial Information System, between 2000 and 2019 there were 1192 unintentional deaths in Australia associated with sport and exercise. Some of the figures for different kinds of sport are shown in the table. Motor sports, other wheeled sports, and water sports are the areas with most fatalities. All combat sports caused less than 1% of sport fatalities. There were more deaths while fishing (23) than from all combat sports (6).

The AMA argues that in other sports the physical injuries that occur are a by-product of body contact, but in boxing they are the deliberate intention of contestants who try to inflict damage to the head and the brain of their opponent. While this claim sounds plausible it actually misrepresents the way boxing is taught and how competitions are organised.

In the bad old days of bareknuckle boxing, a bout ended when one of the participants was so battered he was unable to continue. However, the object of a modern amateur boxing competition is to earn more points with skilful boxing rather than from injuring one's opponent.



Birmingham Museum on Unsplash

While modern prize fighting can be very tough, it is only undertaken by highly trained athletes who are taking calculated risks. They are taking risks in the way that racing car drivers take risks, but the risks taken by prize fighters are much less than those taken by racing car drivers.

Most boxing is an amateur sport in which participants wear protective head gear and use highly padded gloves. Bouts are medically supervised, and the competition is stopped if a participant is even in danger of being injured.

As shown in the graph, there are fewer injuries from boxing than from cycling and motor sports.

Boxing causes about as many injuries as playing netball.

Motor sports	26.9
Other wheeled sports	16.2
Water sports	13.2
Aero sports	9.7
Boating sports	6.9
Equestrian activities	6.5
Team ball sports	2.1
Snow sports	2.1
Combat sports	0.5

Some comparative percentages of fatalities for different sport groups



Sports injury hospitalisations by activity in Australia, by sex, 2020-21

The objections of the AMA to the sport of boxing are not only ill-founded factually, they ignore the special potential benefits of boxing as a sport and the likely consequences of attempting to ban boxing.

Boxing requires and teaches discipline and restraint. Anger and mindless aggression are discouraged as futile. The first thing competitive boxers must learn is to control their emotions. And as attempts to ban alcohol, tobacco and other drugs have shown conclusively, the banning of activities can be counterproductive in that the result is to drive such activities under ground. Unsupervised boxing would be much more dangerous than the current arrangements.

But there is much more to boxing as a sport than just keeping it in the open and under supervision. Boxing has a particular appeal to and significance for some vulnerable and disengaged groups of people who are not likely to be members of the AMA.

These characteristics of boxing as a sport are important incentives for some troubled and disengaged young people. It is widely recognised that the discipline of a boxing gym can have a very positive impact on the lifestyle, health choices and pro-social behaviour of some young people. These are very important lessons for some people.

There are many examples. Take the lived experience of the priest Father Bill Jones. Over many years he has watched some kids in his parish going off the rails and stealing to feed their drug habits. They rob old ladies, take money from other kids and break into houses causing fear and misery in the community.

In response Father Bill, who was a troubled teenager himself before he reformed in a boxing gym, teaches boxing to all comers because he would rather see kids bonding in the gym than bonding in gangs on the street.

'Most kids who train together, or get in the ring together, respect each other and become friends,' he says.

He sees the biggest changes in kids who go far enough with their training to enter an amateur fight.

'They work off their excess energy, feel the changes in their bodies and they are proud to have gone that far, and happy to be off drugs,' he says.

Father Bill's program is not preparing children for boxing careers. Only a tiny number of kids who have amateur fights want to turn professional and take the risks that involves.

'In most cases a couple of fights is enough - they no longer feel the aggression, and they would rather become fitness trainers than fighters'.

Father Bill is particularly proud of one of his kids who recently backed out of a street fight. He knew he could have flattened the other kid and just knowing that he could was enough.

Perhaps these positive benefits of boxing as a sport for disaffected teenagers might be discounted if boxing was as dangerous as the AMA implies, but as the facts show, boxing is not a particularly dangerous sport. Rather than being banned out of self-righteous and middle class ignorance, boxing should be organised and supervised with the safety of willing participants in mind. The positive benefits explained by Father Bill of boxing as a sport should be recognised and endorsed rather than dismissed.

Assessment criteria

Section A will be assessed against the following criteria:

- knowledge and understanding of the text, its structure and the ideas, concerns and values it explores
- development of a clear analysis in response to the topic
- use of evidence from the text to support the analysis
- control of the conventions of the English language to convey meaning

Section B will be assessed against the following criteria:

- use of relevant idea(s) drawn from one Framework of Ideas, the title provided and at least one piece of stimulus material
- creation of a cohesive text that connects to a clear purpose(s)
- use of suitable text structure and language features to create the text
- control of the conventions of the English language to convey meaning

Section C will be assessed against the following criteria:

- understanding of contention, argument(s), and point of view
- analysis of the ways in which written and spoken language and visuals are used to present argument(s) and to persuade an intended audience
- use of evidence from the text to support the analysis
- control of the conventions of the English language to convey meaning

These criteria are from the English sample examination 2023 produced by the Victorian Curriculum and Assessment Authority (VCAA). The VCAA produces the only official, up to date versions of VCAA publications. Readers should consult the VCAA website <http://www.vcaa.vic.edu.au> for VCAA publications and the latest course information.

Acknowledgements

Birmingham Museum on Unsplash
Sports injury hospitalisations by activity in Australia, by sex, 2020–21
AIHW National Hospital Morbidity Rate